

7.1 Toolbars

Slides are slippery things, as the name suggests, and if you want a slide to grab eyeballs, you'll need to plan it well. Once you've finished filling your presentation with points, you'll want to enhance the way it looks on screen. You might want to change colours, alter sizes and shapes, highlight some parts and "lowlight" others—any of dozens of possible improvements. You could use drop-down menus for this—about which this chapter will tell you.

Or, you could use toolbars.

7.1.1 The Convenience Of A Toolbar...

...lies in the fact that it reduces the number of clicks you need to go through to perform a single action. When you open a blank PowerPoint presentation, typically, the following toolbars will be visible apart from the tri-pane view of your presentation:

a) The Standard Toolbar: a row of icons just below the File-Edit-View Quick Access tabs at the top.



The Standard Toolbar is usually along the top of your screen

b) The Formatting Toolbar: usually occupies the right half of the ribbon on which the Standard Toolbar is displayed.



The Formatting Toolbar is usually bundled up in the same strip as the Standard Toolbar

However, you can separate them into two rows by going to Tools > Customize > Options > Show Standard and Formatting Toolbars on two rows.



...but they can be separated into a double ribbon like this

The move handle is an easy way to get the “low-down” on the Formatting toolbar

